GG-D-226E
January 18, 1979
SUPERSEDING
Fed. Spec. GG-D-226D
September 17, 1965

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

DEPRESSOR, TONGUE, WOOD

This specification was approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, for use by all Federal Agencies.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. This specification covers one type of wooden tongue depressor used for examination purposes and other medical applications.

1.2 Classification. The tongue depressors shall be of the following types as specified (see 6.2).

Type I - 100 per box.
Type II - 500 per box.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bid or request for proposal form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein:

Federal Specifications:

UU-P-31	- Paper, General Specifications and Methods of Testing.
PPP-B-566	- Boxes, Folding, Paperboard.
PPP-B-636	- Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard.
PPP-B-676	- Boxes, Setup.

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, US Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.

FSC 6515

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(Single copies of this specification and other Federal Specifications required by activities outside of the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge from Business Service Centers at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, DC, Philadelphia, PA, Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, MO, Fort Worth, Houston, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles and Seattle.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Military Standards:

MIL-STD-105	- Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129	- Marking for Shipment and Storage.
MIL-STD-1363	- Measurement of Wood Moisture Content.

(Copies of Military Specifications, Standards, and Drawings, required by contractors in connection with procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise indicated, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bid or request for proposal shall apply.

National Motor Freight Traffic Association, Inc., Agent.

National Motor Freight Classification.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Trucking Association, Inc., Tariff Order Section, 1616 P Street, N.W., Washington, DC 20036.)

Uniform Classification Committee, Agent.

Uniform Freight Classification Rules.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Uniform Classification Committee, Room 1106, 222 South Riverside Plaza, Chicago, IL 60606.)

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3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Wood. The tongue depressor shall be fabricated of a durable, well seasoned wood, of good quality, such as clear, light, single-ply gum, maple, birch or a similar clear and close-grained hardwood suitable for the purpose intended.

3.2 Design. The tongue depressor shall have parallel sides and rounded ends. The rounded ends shall have a radius equal to one-half the width.

3.3 Finish. The tongue depressor shall be smoothly finished, clean, free from cross grains, knits and fungus growth. The tongue depressor shall be free from splinters, burrs, cracks, dry rot, rough edges or sharp edges.

3.4 Dimensions. The tongue depressor shall have the following dimensions:

length	6, - 1/4, + 17/64 inches
width	3/4, - 1/16, + 5/64 inches
thickness	5/64, + 1/64, - 1/64 inches

3.5 Moisture content. The moisture content of the finished tongue depressors shall range from 6 to 12 percent when tested as specified in 4.4.1.

3.6 Workmanship. Workmanship shall be first class throughout. Item shall be free from defects which detract from its appearance or impair its serviceability. All burrs and sharp edges shall be removed from the item.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract, the contractor may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

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4.1.1 Records. Records of examinations and tests performed by or for the contractor shall be maintained by the contractor and made available to the Government, upon the Government's request, at any time, or from time to time, during the performance of the contract and for a period of three years after delivery of the supplies to which such records relate.

4.1.2 Inspection. Inspection, as used in this specification, is defined as both examination (such as visual and auditory investigation without the use of special laboratory appliances or procedures) and testing (determination by technical means of physical and chemical properties) of the item.

4.1.3 Certificates of quality. Certificates of quality, supplied by the manufacturer of the materials may be furnished in lieu of actual performance of such testing by the contractor, provided lot identity has been maintained and can be demonstrated to the Government. The certificate shall include the name of the contractor, the contract number, the name of the manufacturer or supplier, the NSN, the Item Identification, the name of the component/material, the lot number, the lot size, the sample size, the date of testing, the test method, individual test results, and the specification requirements.

4.2 Sampling.

4.2.1 For examination. Sampling for examination shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105 and as indicated in table I. The unit of product for examination purposes shall be one tongue depressor.

TABLE I. Sampling for examination

Type of defect	Inspection level	AQL (percent defective)
Major	II	4.0
Minor	II	6.5

4.2.2 For tests. Sampling for tests shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105 and as indicated in table II. The unit of product for test purposes shall be one tongue depressor. When possible, the same sample unit shall be used for the determination of two or more test characteristics.

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TABLE II. Sampling for tests

Component	Characteristic	Requirement	Test procedure	Inspection level	AQL (percent defective)
Tongue depressor	Dimensions	3.4	-----	S-1	2.5
	Moisture content	3.5	4.4.1	II	1.0

4.3 Examination.

4.3.1 Tongue depressors. The tongue depressors shall be examined to determine compliance with all the requirements contained in this specification. Examination shall be conducted as specified in tables I and III. Examination, however, shall not be restricted to defects listed in table III.

TABLE III. Classification of defects

Categories	Defects
Major	
101	Material not clear, close grained hardwood.
102	Depressor not free of knot-holes, splits, cuts, cracks, dry rot. or breaks.
103	Edges not free of splinters, burrs, rough edges or sharp edges.
104	Surfaces, including side faces, not smooth and free of roughness or splinters.
105	Depressor not free of fungus growth.
Minor	
201	Not free of warped or distorted sections.
202	Not free of knots.
203	Ends not properly rounded as specified (see 3.2).
204	Side surfaces not parallel (by visual examination).
205	Not free of wood dust and debris.

4.3.2 Examination of preparation for delivery. An examination shall be made to determine compliance with the packaging, packing and marking requirements of section 5. Sampling shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105. The lot shall be the number of containers offered for inspection at one time. The inspection level shall be S-2 with an AQL of 4.0 expressed in terms of percent defective.

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TABLE IV. Examination of preparation for delivery

Examine	Defect
Contents	Not as specified.
Container	Not as specified.
Marking	Omitted; incorrect; illegible; improper size, location, sequence or method of application.
Packaging and packing material	Component missing or damaged.
Workmanship	Bulging or distortion of container.

4.3.2.1 Examination of closure, waterproofing and banding of container. When the container is required to comply with PPP-B-566, PPP-B-676, or PPP-B-636, the examination for defects in closure, waterproofing or banding shall be in accordance with the appendix of the appropriate box specification.

4.4 Tests. Tests shall be conducted to determine compliance with specification requirements.

4.4.1 Moisture content. The finished tongue depressor shall be used as the test specimen. Determination of moisture content shall be accomplished by the oven drying method specified in MIL-STD-1363.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging. Packaging shall be level A or C (commercial), as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 Level A.

5.1.1.1 Unit package.

5.1.1.1.1 Type I. One hundred clean and dry tongue depressors shall be packaged in a box conforming to PPP-B-566 or PPP-B-676. Closure shall be as specified in the applicable box specification.

5.1.1.1.2 Type II. Five hundred clean and dry tongue depressors shall be packaged in a box conforming to PPP-B-566, PPP-B-636, class domestic or PPP-B-676. Closure shall be as specified in the applicable box specification.

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5.1.2 Intermediate package. Twelve unit packages containing type I depressors or two unit packages containing type II depressors shall be packaged in a box conforming to PPP-B-636, class domestic. Closure shall be as specified in the box specification.

5.1.3 Level C (commercial). Tongue depressors shall be clean and dry. One hundred type I depressors or five hundred type II depressors shall be packaged in a manner that will afford adequate protection against deterioration and physical damage during shipment from the supply source to the first receiving activity.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B or C (commercial), as specified (see 6.2).

5.2.1 Level A. Six intermediate packages containing depressors of one type only shall be packed in a shipping container designed for a type 2 load and conforming to PPP-B-636, class weather-resistant. Closure, banding and waterproofing shall be as specified in the box specification.

5.2.2 Level B. Six intermediate packages containing depressors of one type only shall be packaged in a box designed for a type 2 load and conforming to PPP-B-636, class domestic. Closure shall be as specified in the appendix of the box specification.

5.2.3 Level C (commercial). The packaged tongue depressors shall be packed in a shipping container in a manner that will afford adequate protection against damage during direct delivery from the supply source to the first receiving activity. These packs shall conform to the carrier's rules and regulations.

5.3 Marking.

5.3.1 Civil agencies. Marking for shipments shall be as specified in the contract or order.

5.3.2 Military activities. Each unit, intermediate and shipping container shall be marked as specified in MIL-STD-129.

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6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. The tongue depressor covered by this specification is intended for use in examination and other medical applications.

6.2 Ordering data. Purchasers should select the preferred options permitted herein and include the following information in procurement documents.

a. Title, number and date of this specification.
b. Type required (see 1.2).
c. Selection of applicable levels of packaging and packing (see 5.1 and 5.2).
d. National stock number.
e. Marking - civil agencies (see 5.3.1).

6.3 National stock number. This specification covers the following item(s) appearing in the Federal Supply catalog or General Services Administration Supply Catalog:

National Stock Number	Item Identification
6515-00-324-5500	DEPRESSOR, TONGUE, Wood, 100's
6515-00-753-4533	DEPRESSOR, TONGUE, Wood, 500's

MILITARY CUSTODIANS:
Army - MD
Navy - MS
Air Force - 03

Preparing activity:
DLA - DM

Civil Agency Coordinating activities:
GSA - FSS
HEW-FDA

Review activity:
DOD - MB

Project No. 6515-2176

Orders for this publication are to be placed with General Services Administration, acting as an agent for the Superintendent of Documents. See section 2 of this specification to obtain extra copies and other documents referenced herein.

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